MODULE 3 INSIDER PLAYBOOK - THE PITCH WEAPON: What the Promotion Industry Knows About Attention

Executive insider briefing - confidential

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Executive briefing. The craft layer under the lessons. Read after 3.1-3.4.

THE FOUR-SECOND STACK (THE ACTUAL ATTENTION ECONOMY)

- Inbox preview (4s) - subject line + sender + first line. If the subject is vague, dead.
- Body scan (4s) - "who is this, is there a receipt, what's the ask?" If the proof isn't in the first 20 words, dead.
- Asset sample (4s) - one click: is the audio playable in 60 seconds? If it needs a player, a login, or a download, dead.
- Ask decision (4s) - is the request yes-able in one sentence? If the ask is a list, dead.

Design every payload to win all four stacks before the PD has to think. That's what the 90-word pitch, the one-page EPK, and the 3-file audio package are for. The weapon isn't the pitch - it's the zero-thought path to a yes.

THE DOMAIN & DELIVERY PROTOCOL (THE HIDDEN CREDIBILITY SIGNAL)

- Send from a real domain, not gmail.com. pitch@yourname.com reads operator; yourname99@gmail.com reads bedroom. Domain + professional signature is the cheapest status signal in the game.
- Never send a zip, a folder, or a Dropbox link that requires a click-through. One link per payload. One attachment per payload (the 90-sec file). Everything else lives on the EPK page.
- File naming is branding: ARTIST-SONG-90SEC, ARTIST-SONG-CLEAN-WAV, ARTIST-EPK. A PD forwarding your file forwards your professionalism.
- Test the mobile path - 80% of first opens happen on a phone. Open your own email on your phone and time it: how many seconds until the song is playing? If it's over 60, rework the payload.

THE PROOF-SHAPING TRICK (HOW LABELS FRAME RECEIPTS)

A receipt is a fact. Framing is the weapon. Same number, different command.

- Raw: "2,100 streams this month."
- Framed: "2,100 streams this month - [NUMBER] of them in [your station's metro], up [NUMBER]% since the radio adds."
- Super-framed: "[Sister station] added it last week and [metro] streams jumped [NUMBER]% - this is the track your audience is already showing up for."

Always include: the market, the trend, and the third-party source. A PD doesn't buy your number - they buy the direction of your number in their market.

THE TWO-EMAIL SYSTEM (THE INDUSTRY'S ACTUAL CADENCE)

- Wave A - the service email: subject + proof + ask (your 90-word pitch). Purpose: get the listen.
- Wave B - the value email (48h later): "here's the 90-sec promo built for your board" or "here's the listener-proof from [metro]." Purpose: get the add.

Wave B is where most adds actually land - and 90% of independents never send it because they think one email equals one campaign. The two-email system is the single highest-ROI change in this module.

THE SUBJECT-LINE MATH (BORROWED FROM DIRECT-RESPONSE)

- 4-7 words wins. Long subjects get truncated on mobile - and truncation kills the engine.
- Personal names in subjects lift opens on cold lists. Numbers in subjects lift opens on proof-led lists. Format-show references lift opens on specialty lists. Match the engine to the station type, or the open dies.
- Never reuse a subject that failed twice. Two failures = the angle is wrong for that list; change engines, not words.
- Track everything in T3.1. Your personal data of your market beats every general rule ever written.

THE AUDIO WEAPON: WHAT LABELS ACTUALLY SERVICE

- The 90-second promo (hook + voice + CTA) - the pitch in audio form.
- The radio edit (clean, 3:00-3:45, hook < 12s) - the inventory.
- The 30-second payload (for IDs, beds, and the promo team) - the derivative that gets forwarded.

Produce all three before the first send. The hour you spend in the studio saves 20 hours of campaign repair - because a PD who has to ask "do you have a clean edit?" is a PD who hasn't added you yet.

THE ONE SECRET MOST ARTISTS NEVER LEARN

The reply you want is not "we'll play it." The reply you want is a question. "Send the WAV," "what's the clean edit?" - that's the PD engaging with the logistics of saying yes, which means the decision is already 80% made. When you get a question, treat it as a yes in progress: answer within 4 hours with a phone number and a 12-minute call offer. This is the highest-leverage moment in the entire campaign and almost nobody recognizes it.